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At Close Quarters: A Nation Responds

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The day began with a phone call from Jo.

Under the cover of darkness, the PLA had moved troops from Moldo to the area of Chuti Changla, towards the South Bank of the Pangong Tso. They had done this in two phases in the night of 29/30 August 2020, starting from about 0100 hours, in two parties of about forty to fifty personnel each, followed by another such group at 0230 hours. Given the circumstances, our troops were on high alert and had monitored this entire move. The assessment was that the PLA would try and repeat what they had done on the North Bank and try to occupy dominating features on their perception of the LAC. We had been alive to this possibility and as soon as we came to know of this development, Northern Command immediately decided to move troops up and pre-empt the PLA. These plans had been deliberated upon earlier and troops had been earmarked for the purpose. Thus began a race to the ridge lines.

While this was in progress, I called up the RM, EAM and NSA and gave them a quick rundown of events, including our own response. I also suggested that a CSG meeting that was

Four Stars of Destiny.indd 288 11/28/2023 12:45:19 PM